

This roadmap  
online

# B.A. in Music roadmap: composition and production electives, two years for transfer students

Entry at junior standing with an Associate Degree for Transfer (AA-T) in Music · Music office:  
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| Degree                    | Entry                               | In residence | Catalog   |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------|-----------|
| Bachelor of Arts in Music | Transfer, AA-T, fall A (even years) | 60 units     | 2027–2028 |

## 01 Units in residence

| Component                         | Units      |
|-----------------------------------|------------|
| Music requirements and electives* | 39         |
| General education                 | 9          |
| Free electives**                  | 12         |
| <b>Total in residence</b>         | <b>60</b>  |
| AA-T                              | 60         |
| <b>B.A. total</b>                 | <b>120</b> |

\*Plus up to 6 units for transfer students: 3 for the keyboard sequence (MUS 118, MUS 119, and MUS 218) and 3 for MUS 202 Writing About Music.

\*\*These vary depending on each student's path through the GE requirements and free electives, up to 120 units.

The music electives in this plan are composition and production courses.

Applied lessons begin after an applied area placement: an audition on the student's instrument or voice, or a creative portfolio in composition or music production.

String players take Chamber Orchestra (MUS 365) as their Major Performing Ensemble.

## 02 Before the first semester

The B.A. requires three semesters of keyboard musicianship: MUS 118, MUS 119, and MUS 218. Transfer students who haven't completed the sequence take it at CSU East Bay or meet the requirement by credit by exam.

The B.A. requires MUS 202 Writing About Music. Transfer students who haven't completed GE Second Composition will need to fulfill that requirement with this course.

The B.A. requires MUS 381 Essentials of Music Technology. Transfer students who haven't completed a similar technology course will need to fulfill that requirement with this course during their first semester.

General education paths differ from student to student. The GE courses shown are one typical selection for music majors. Students build their own GE plan with an advisor.

The Certificate in Music Education counts within the B.A. units in residence, with up to 4 units beyond the 60 units in residence. Its roadmap shows the semester placement of the certificate courses.

## 03 Semester by semester

☐ Music ☐ General education

### Fifth semester (fall A)

| Course                | Title                                                            | Units     |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| UD GE 4               | Upper-division Social and Behavioral Sciences                    | 3         |
| MUS 323               | Topics in Western Music History                                  | 3         |
| MUS 312               | Form and Analysis                                                | 3         |
| MUS 461–469           | Applied Composition or Music Production (applied area placement) | 1         |
| MUS 351–359           | Major Performing Ensemble                                        | 1         |
|                       | Free electives                                                   | 3         |
| <b>Semester total</b> |                                                                  | <b>14</b> |

### Seventh semester (fall B)

| Course                | Title                                                      | Units     |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| MUS 304               | World Music & Culture                                      | 3         |
| MUS 410               | 20th and 21st C Styles and Techniques                      | 3         |
| MUS 461–469           | Applied Composition or Music Production (portfolio review) | 1         |
| MUS 351–359           | Major Performing Ensemble                                  | 1         |
| MUS 360–369           | Chamber Ensemble                                           | 1         |
|                       | Free electives                                             | 6         |
| <b>Semester total</b> |                                                            | <b>15</b> |

### Sixth semester (spring A)

| Course                | Title                                                      | Units     |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| UD GE 5               | Upper-division Science and Quantitative Reasoning          | 3         |
| UWR                   | University Writing Requirement                             | 3         |
| MUS 324               | History of American Music                                  | 3         |
| MUS 461–469           | Applied Composition or Music Production (portfolio review) | 1         |
| MUS 351–359           | Major Performing Ensemble                                  | 1         |
| MUS 485               | Advanced Sound Design I: Sampling, Editing, and Mixing     | 3         |
| MUS 414               | Contemporary Orchestration and Arranging                   | 3         |
| <b>Semester total</b> |                                                            | <b>17</b> |

### Eighth semester (spring B)

| Course                | Title                                                                                | Units     |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| MUS 461–469           | Applied Composition or Music Production (portfolio review)                           | 1         |
| MUS 351–359           | Major Performing Ensemble                                                            | 1         |
| MUS 486               | Advanced Sound Design II: Synthesis, Modulation & Creative Digital Signal Processing | 3         |
| MUS 412               | Contrapuntal Techniques                                                              | 3         |
|                       | Free electives                                                                       | 6         |
| <b>Semester total</b> |                                                                                      | <b>14</b> |

## 04 Music electives

Students choose 12 units. Up to 4 additional units of Applied Music Study, 4 additional units of Major Performing Ensembles, and 7 additional units of Chamber Ensembles also count toward electives.

#### Music education

MUS 331 Foundations of Music Education, 3  
 MUS 335 Technology for Music Educators, 3  
 MUS 431 Elementary Music Teaching Methods, 3  
 MUS 432 Instrumental Music Teaching Methods, 3  
 MUS 433 Choral Music Teaching Methods, 3  
 MUS 445 Piano Pedagogy, 2  
 MUS 446 Vocal Pedagogy, 2  
 MUS 495 Music Education Practicum, 1

MUS 497 Contemporary Issues in Music Education, 3

#### Conducting

MUS 341 Basic Conducting, 3  
 MUS 441 Intermediate Conducting, 3

#### Composition and music production

MUS 280 Composers Workshop, 1  
 MUS 412 Contrapuntal Techniques, 3  
 MUS 414 Contemporary Orchestration and Arranging, 3  
 MUS 415 MIDI Orchestration, 3  
 MUS 485 Advanced Sound Design I: Sampling, Editing, and Mixing, 3

MUS 486 Advanced Sound Design II: Synthesis, Modulation & Creative Digital Signal Processing, 3

#### History and global music

MUS 305 Global Hip-Hop, 3  
 MUS 326 Topics in Global Music, 3

#### Entrepreneurship and research

MUS 303 Entrepreneurship in the Arts, 3  
 MUS 490 Independent Study, 1–3  
 MUS 498 Internship, 1–3

#### Performance

MUS 317 Improvisation Techniques, 1